

11 Putting Things Together

Definition 11.1: Graph.

A *graph* G is determined by a *finite* set of *vertices* $V(G)$ and a set of *edges* $E(G)$ satisfying $E(G) \subseteq \{W \mid W \subseteq V(G) \wedge |W| = 2\}$.

Definition 11.2: Path.

Let G be a graph. A “*walk*” along G is meant to denote a possible way of visiting the vertices of G by traveling along the edges. Given a natural number $k \in \mathbb{N}$, we define a *walk of length k on G* to be a function $f : (k + 1) \rightarrow V(G)$ such that, for each $i < k$, we have $\{f(i), f(i + 1)\} \in E(G)$.¹ A *path* is a walk that does not repeat any nodes; more formally, a *path of length k on G* is an injective walk of length k on G .²

Definition 11.3: Cycle.

Given $k \in \mathbb{N}$, a *circuit of length k* on a graph G is a walk $w : k + 1 \rightarrow V(G)$ that starts and ends at the same place, meaning $w(0) = w(k)$. If a circuit does not repeat any nodes other than the first and last ones,³ then we call this circuit a *cycle*.

Theorem 11.1: Handshake Lemma (v. 1).

For any graph G , we have $\sum_{v \in V(G)} \deg_G(v) = 2 \cdot |E(G)|$.

Theorem 11.2: Handshake Lemma (v. 2).

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Theorem 11.3: Handshake Lemma (v. 3).

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¹This means that consecutive nodes $f(i)$ and $f(i + 1)$ along the walk must be connected by an edge in G .

²Notice the *length* of a walk or path is determined by the number of *edges* involved, not the number of *vertices*.

³... meaning the walk is essentially a *path* except for the fact that the first and last nodes are the same...